MY AUTOBIOGRAPHY

Introduction

My name is Alvin Karanja Mbogo and this is the story of my life a journey marked by transformation, resilience, faith, and the pursuit of purpose. Born and raised in Kenya, I have walked through seasons of laughter and pain, triumph and failure, friendship and solitude. Each chapter of my life has shaped the man I am today, and through this autobiography, I open the doors to my past so that others may glimpse the lessons, joys, and struggles that have defined me.

This narrative is more than just a recollection of events, it's a testament of growth and grace. From my childhood days playing under the sun in central Kenya to the sleepless nights in university struggling with purpose and provision, this story captures the essence of a life lived with intention, mistakes, and miracles. I write this not to boast, but to reflect. Not to impress, but to express. Because every life, no matter how ordinary it may seem, has value, and every voice deserves to be heard. As you read these pages, may you see beyond the words. May you feel the heartbeat of someone who has faced change with courage, embraced failure with humility, and chased dreams with hope. I pray that my story inspires you to reflect on your own, and that it reminds you: we are all stories still being written by experience, by choice, and by the grace of God.

Early Childhood and Family Roots

I was born on 6th September, 2003, in Kenya, into a humble yet loving family. My childhood memories are steeped in the warm embrace of simple life, surrounded by rolling hills, seasonal rivers, and the scent of acacia trees. Our home was nestled in a small town full of vibrant colors and louder laughter. My parents, hardworking and visionary, were the pillars of our household. They instilled in me the virtues of honesty, faith, and diligence.

My father, a humble yet wise man, worked tirelessly as a food processing factory and occasionally took up painting and repair projects to support our family. He was a man of principle, always emphasizing the importance of integrity and responsibility. He believed in leading by example and taught us to take pride in even the smallest of duties.

My mother, on the other hand, was a warm-hearted woman with unmatched strength and patience. She was the heart of our home tending to our needs, encouraging our dreams, and offering the kind of comfort that only a mother could give. Her calm voice and unwavering faith were the anchors that held us steady through life's storms. I grew up with one sibling, a younger brother with be being the eldest by one and a half years.

My brother, Telvin, was the mischievous yet brilliant spark in our family. He had an endless curiosity and was always building or fixing something, he was the cheerful soul whose laughter brightened every room. We were each other's first friends, confidants, and fiercest protectors. Our home was always lively. The compound was constantly buzzing with activity. The neighborhood kids were like extended family. I was especially close to three of them Ishmael, a stubborn and mischievous boy with a contagious laugh; Michael, a curious boy who loved insects; and Erick, who was shy but incredibly imaginative. Together, we created worlds out of nothing. We played "bano" (a game made from small marble spheres), hide and seek in the town area section blocks and acted out stories we invented on the spot. Life felt magical, filled with imagination and joy.

During holidays, our days started with morning chores, followed by hours of play under the scorching sun. We climbed mango and avocado trees, raced old tires down the dusty paths, and shared stories around evening sunset. We were united by innocence, adventure, and the pure thrill of childhood. Twice during my early years, our family relocated. The first move happened when I was six. My father got a new job, and we had to leave our section. Saying goodbye to my friends was heartbreaking. I remember crying in secret, unsure of how to make new friends in a place that felt foreign. It took time, but eventually, I found a new rhythm.

I met Mugo and Brian at my new home, and slowly, laughter returned. The second move came three years later. By then, I had learned that change, while painful, also brought new beginnings. This time, I embraced the move with cautious hope. It wasn't always easy to adjust each new environment had its own customs so to say, its own way of doing things but I learned to adapt, to listen, and to observe before speaking.

These moves shaped me into someone resilient and open-minded. What I cherish most about my childhood are the simple moments: going hunting for wild rabbits and birds on weekends, listening to my mother narrate folktales, and attending church as a family. These were more than routines they were the threads that wove our lives together. Even with the challenges of shifting homes and building new friendships, my early years were a rich blend of love, adventure, and quiet lessons. They laid the foundation for the person I would become curious, grounded, and full of gratitude for the beauty of a simple, connected life.

The Formative Years of Education Primary School Years I began my formal education at Major Junior School in 2007. Walking into class on my first day, I was both anxious and excited. The classrooms smelled of chalk and dusty floors, and the air was filled with the laughter of children and the stern voices of teachers. That was the beginning of a journey that would shape my identity in ways I could not have imagined. My primary school life was quite nomadic. I shifted to three different schools during my primary

years due to family relocations and changing circumstances. Each school brought with it new challenges, new friendships, and new teachers.

At first, the constant moving felt like a punishment I would make friends and then be forced to leave them behind. But with time, I learned to adapt, to quickly make friends, and to make every school feel like home. Interestingly, the third and final primary school I returned to was Major Junior School, where my academic journey had first begun. Coming back to familiar walls and 3 faces felt both comforting and motivating. In Class 6, something unexpected happened. I began to dread school. I found excuses to avoid going. There were days I pretended to be sick, faking headaches or stomach pains just to stay home. Looking back, I realize it wasn't the learning that scared me, but the pressure, the social dynamics, and my own insecurities. But everything changed in Class 7.

That was my turning point. It was during this time that I met Teacher Mathenge, our mathematics teacher. He had a way of turning numbers into stories, formulas into games. For the first time, mathematics made sense. I began to see patterns, connections, and beauty in what once seemed like gibberish. His encouragement and belief in me lit a spark that has never gone out. I started to look forward to his lessons and found myself spending extra time solving problems, not because I had to, but because I wanted to. Class 7 was also when I began excelling academically. My grades shot up, especially in mathematics and science.

The boy who used to avoid school was now standing in front of the class, receiving awards and leading discussions. It was a transformation that shocked even me. And somewhere in the middle of all this academic awakening, I experienced my first innocent taste of young love. Her name was Joy. She was a quiet girl with a kind smile and a love for swimming. We met in my second school, and we would often walk home from school together, talking about everything from our favorite foods to our dreams. It was all so innocent and sweet just holding hands during lunch break felt like an adventure. Though we eventually went separate ways after I changed schools again, Joy holds a warm place in my childhood memories.

In Class 8, another significant friendship blossomed Aisha. She was a gentle and thoughtful girl with a heart of gold. What made Aisha stand out wasn't just her radiant personality, but also her story. Aisha had been left by her birth mother when she was very young and was adopted by a kind Indian couple who raised her with so much love and grace. Despite her past, she never let it dim her spirit. Her resilience and kindness inspired me deeply.

She was the kind of friend who noticed when you were quiet, who laughed wholeheartedly and who always shared her snacks. We became inseparable. From revising together under a shade during lunch breaks to whispering dreams and secrets

under our desks, Aisha became like a sister. But in the third term of Class 8, Aisha's parents transferred her to another school.

That moment taught me the depth of real friendship and the pain of unexpected goodbyes. Despite the shifts, the struggles, and the surprises, my primary education years were foundational. They taught me to believe in myself, to embrace change, and to find joy even in uncertainty. Most importantly, they introduced me to a lifelong love for learning, especially in mathematics a love that continues to define my path today. High School Years After completing my primary education, I was admitted to Njiiri School School, located in the heart of Central Kenya.

The school was surrounded by cool lush Aberdare Ranges, abundant water resources, and a serene environment that made it feel like a retreat. The natural beauty of the place complemented the calm and welcoming atmosphere created by the kindhearted people I met there. From the beginning, I immersed myself fully in school life. I joined the basketball club, and my passion for the game led me to participate in school tournaments and regional competitions.

Our team made it all the way to the national level a journey that was exciting yet full of challenges. We often practiced late into the evening, sacrificed weekends. But the friendships we built and the pride of performing at such a level made every hardship worthwhile.

Academically, my high school journey was a blend of triumphs and trials. My love for mathematics that began in Class 7 continued to shine. The foundation built by Teacher Felix helped me excel in math throughout high school. It became my strongest subject one that I not only enjoyed but also excelled in during every exam. However, chemistry was a different story at least in the beginning. In Form 1 and Form 2, I struggled to grasp the concepts. The subject felt like an unsolvable puzzle, and my marks reflected that. But everything changed when we were assigned a new teacher, Mr. Wanjihi. He had a gift for simplifying complex concepts and made the periodic table feel like a friendly map. His insistence on organized work, extra questions, proper files, and well-written summary notes turned things around. Chemistry went from being my worst subject to one of my best, thanks to his dedication and unique teaching style. Another unforgettable character in my high school journey was Mr. Manyara the most feared teacher in the school. Known for his strictness and discipline, he later became my business studies teacher. At first, I was terrified of him. One day, our class performed terribly on a test, and he gave us a tough punishment that none of us will ever forget. But as time went by, we grew to respect his teaching methods. He taught the accounting section of business studies with such clarity that it began to make sense. He demanded well-organized files, accurate extra work, and clean, detailed summaries. Under his guidance, we performed excellently in business studies. Our school also experienced a change in leadership during my time there. We received a new principal

who brought fresh energy and reforms that greatly improved the school environment. Discipline was upheld with compassion, and academic standards were raised. In Form 3 and Form 4, I was honored to serve as a class prefect. This role taught me responsibility, patience, and how to be a supportive leader among my peers. It was during these years that I formed close bonds with two younger students, Joseph and Kanyi. They became my school brothers and we shared many memorable moments. But as time passed, misunderstandings and emotional strains caused the friendship to break down. That falling out deeply affected me for a while. It was a painful lesson on the complexity of human relationships. Finally, the KCSE season arrived the culmination of four intense years. That period was filled with sleepless nights, endless revision sessions, and nervous prayers. We pushed ourselves, encouraged one another, and held on to our dreams. Walking into the exam room each day, I carried with me not just formulas and facts, but memories, sacrifices and the hope of a bright future.

Campus Life

Growth, Purpose, and Possibility

After earning strong grades in high school, I was blessed with the opportunity to pursue a Bachelor Degree in Information Technology at Dedan Kimathi University of Technology. Transitioning to campus life was like stepping into a new dimension a space filled with freedom, unfamiliarity, and a multitude of opportunities. Unlike primary and high school, where routines were strictly defined and guided by bells and schedules, campus demanded a whole new level of self-discipline, adaptability, and a clear sense of purpose.

My first year in campus was incredibly challenging, especially financially. Coming from a modest background, I struggled to meet basic needs, let alone pay for my tuition. It was a difficult time, filled with anxiety, sleepless nights, and uncertainty about my future. But amidst the storm, I found an anchor in faith. Some of the friends I met in church became my greatest support system encouraging me, praying for me, and occasionally even helping me meet small financial needs. Their love reminded me that I was never alone. It was during this time that I met my close friend, Davyne. She was kind, witty, and had a heart full of compassion. We bonded over shared dreams and hopes and she quickly became a constant source of encouragement. Our friendship added color and laughter to some of the darkest days. Interestingly, campus also reunited me with a few guys I had schooled with in high school. The familiarity of their presence gave me a sense of home, and they were instrumental in helping me adjust to the new environment. Their academic tips, emotional support, and late night revision sessions became lifelines. As I embraced my new identity and relationship with Christ, I also made some difficult decisions. One of them was breaking up with the girlfriend I had before joining campus. I

had outgrown that version of myself, and my newfound values and life perspective no longer aligned with the relationship. Though painful, it was a necessary step toward aligning my life with God's will and embracing the man I was becoming. It was during one of those quiet seasons in campus when everything seemed to blur between assignments, spiritual growth, and personal discovery that I met him. We were attending a joint fellowship meeting hosted by several university Christian unions. The evening was cold and misty, but the warmth in the room was undeniable. As the worship rose and testimonies flowed, my eyes were drawn to a young woman seated across the room. There was nothing boastful or loud about her; it was the stillness in her presence that captured my attention. She sat quietly, deeply engrossed in the Word, occasionally nodding during the sermon as if having an internal conversation with God. I didn't know it then, but that quiet strength would soon become one of the most comforting constants in my life. Our paths crossed again a few weeks later during a prayer walk, where students paired randomly to pray and encourage one another. When I was assigned to walk with her, we laughed awkwardly at first both surprised, both reserved. But as we strolled through the tree-lined paths of the campus, conversation flowed effortlessly. We talked about our upbringings, our struggles with faith, our dreams, and our fears. She listened without rushing to reply, spoke with thoughtfulness, and asked questions that showed genuine interest. Days turned into weeks, and our conversations moved from post-fellowship moments to shared lunches, long texts, weekend library study sessions and outings that often ended in laughter. With time, she wasn't just someone I talked to she became someone I deeply looked forward to being around. She reminded me what it felt like to be seen, truly seen. Falling in love with her wasn't a sudden spark it was a slow, steady flame, nurtured by prayer, trust, and kindness. She celebrated my small wins, prayed with me when I felt weak, and often reminded me of who I was in Christ. With her, I felt safe, safe to dream, safe to doubt and safe to be vulnerable. There were no games, no pressure—only sincerity and presence. She respected my values and honored my walk with God. We built our relationship on a foundation of friendship and faith, and even during disagreements, there was always a gentle return to grace. She became a mirror of God's love in human form not perfect, but deeply purposeful. Meeting her didn't complete me, but it affirmed everything I had prayed for in a partner and even now, I look back at those beginning days with a smile, knowing that what we found was not by chance—it was a divine orchestration, a love story written by the Author of time Himself. Beyond academics and spirituality, I found a new passion in entrepreneurship. I started a small snack-selling business. At first, it was just biscuits, juice boxes, and sweets tucked into a bag. But gradually, it evolved into a mini-venture. I began keeping inventory, sourcing stock in bulk, and even learning a bit about marketing. This hustle taught me vital business skills—budgeting, time management, negotiation, and resilience. The advantages were many: I gained financial independence, built networks, and learned to think creatively. However, it wasn't all rosy. Juggling classes and business was exhausting. There were days I would miss

meals to ensure my stock was replenished. There were times sales were low, and I would feel discouraged. There were also occasional misunderstandings with customers or school authorities over selling in unauthorized areas. But every struggle taught me something invaluable. Of course, life in Kimathi came with its own unique set of challenges. Nyeri's weather was biting cold, especially for someone who was used to warmer climates. The foggy mornings, icy showers, and constant need for jackets became part of my routine. Yet, over time, even the cold became a metaphor for endurance a challenge to embrace rather than escape. I also began building social connections. I formed what I thought would be my lifelong friendship with my first best friend in campus. At first, everything was great, we studied together, prayed together, and dreamed together. But as time passed, cracks began to show. Misunderstandings turned into conflict, and eventually, the friendship ended in silence. The heartbreak of losing someone I held dear left a deep scar, and for a while, I vowed never to open myself up to close friendships again. But as life would have it, healing came in the form of another girl gentle, understanding, and sincere. She became my favorite. Unlike any other friend, she gave me space to be vulnerable and didn't demand perfection. Slowly, I learned to trust again, to laugh again, and to believe in the beauty of friendship. Campus life, with all its ups and downs, shaped me into a multifaceted individual. It taught me resilience, discipline, compassion, and courage. It exposed me to the complexities of adulthood the responsibility of finances, the weight of relationships, the strength of faith, and the power of purpose. Now, with just one more month before I finalize, I look back with a heart full of gratitude. Campus was more than a place of learning it was a furnace and a sanctuary, a battlefield and a home. It molded me, broke me, built me, and blessed me. I step into the future with boldness, not because I have all the answers, but because I've seen the grace of God carry me through every season.

Vision for the Future

As I prepare to close this chapter of my academic journey, I look ahead with hope and clarity. My desire is to apply the skills and lessons I've learned in software and web development, data science, and entrepreneurship to solve real-world problems especially in tech spaces, education, and community development. I envision a future where I not only work in impactful spaces but also mentor young women and men who need direction, just as I once did. I want to build a business that creates jobs, inspires innovation, and uplifts my community. Spiritually, I aspire to grow in my walk with God, continually anchoring my purpose in His will and sharing His love with others. This is not the end it's a beginning, full of grace, grit, and God's guidance. Activities and Experiences Outside School Throughout my life, learning has never been confined to the classroom. The experiences and activities I engaged in outside school hours shaped my personality, built my confidence, and broadened my worldview in ways no textbook ever could. From the playful chaos of childhood games to the disciplined hustle of entrepreneurship and spiritual growth, my journey outside school has been just as

transformative as my formal education. Primary School Years: Imagination, Play, and Discovery My earliest memories of life outside school are filled with joyful chaos. After school, the neighborhood came alive with children's voices. We formed groups instinctively, drawn together by the love of play. I would rush home, toss my schoolbag into the house, and join friends like Michael, Mugo, and Erick in our little universe of games. Our favorites were hide and seek, "bano" (small marble ball game), tyre riding, and storytelling competitions. Every corner of the village became a playground guava trees for climbing, dusty paths for racing, and riverbanks for throwing stones and catching fish. On weekends, my brother and I were assigned chores early in the morning fetching water, sweeping, or helping our mother in the garden. These chores, though tiresome at times, taught us responsibility. When the chores were done, we would spend time with cousins visiting from Nairobi or help our grandmother with livestock. I particularly enjoyed watching her milk the cows or tell folktales by the fireplace. These stories carried deep morals and traditions, planting early seeds of cultural pride and understanding. I was also part of the children's choir at our local church. Singing brought me a sense of belonging. I loved dressing in uniform and traveling to other churches for performances. The applause we received and the friendships formed during those trips were magical to me. I also once participated in a Sunday school memory verse competition and proudly took second place a small but significant achievement that sparked my early interest in public speaking. High School Years: Leadership, Creativity, and Deep Friendships High school was a time of blossoming. I joined Njiiri School, nestled in the scenic highlands of central Kenya, a place blessed with rich vegetation and a cool environment. Beyond academics, I was drawn to co-curricular activities that allowed me to express myself and interact with others. One of the most defining experiences was my participation in basketball club. What began as a hobby quickly turned into passion. I took part in several game tournaments and interschool friendly matches, playing different positions that pushed me out of my comfort zone. We would practice late into the evening, sometimes battling cold weather and exhaustion. The thrill of performing before large audiences and moving on to national level competitions was exhilarating. These moments taught me confidence, teamwork, and the importance of preparation. High school also opened doors to leadership opportunities. In Form 3, I was appointed class prefect.

Managing classmates, coordinating assignments, and acting as a link between students and teachers sharpened my communication skills and sense of accountability. It was no easy task, but I learned to handle criticism, resolve conflicts, and earn respect through fairness. Outside academics, I also found joy in mentorship and bonding. Weekends in high school meant attending fellowship, cleaning duties, or quietly reading novels from the school library. I was particularly drawn to inspirational books and African literature. During school holidays, I volunteered at church youth events and occasionally helped with organizing local community projects like tree planting or cleaning up the marketplace.

Campus Life: Entrepreneurship, Spiritual Awakening, and Self Discovery

Campus life brought the most diverse and mature experiences outside the classroom. With more freedom came more responsibility and more opportunities for growth. At Dedan Kimathi University, my days outside lecture halls were filled with activities that shaped the person I am today. One of my proudest journeys was in entrepreneurship. In my second semester, I began selling snacks biscuits, sweets, juice boxes, and samosas to fellow students. What began as a way to make ends meet quickly turned into a learning platform. I learned how to manage stock, handle customer relations, calculate profits, and track expenses. Some days were tough—I'd walk long distances across campus just to deliver a 20-shilling order. But the satisfaction of building something of my own was unmatched. I made loyal customers, learned negotiation, and even inspired a few friends to start their own businesses. But the campus wasn't just about hustle. It was also where my spiritual life deepened. I joined a Christian fellowship group and gradually became active in ministry. I participated in Bible studies, praise and worship sessions, and youth conferences. Through these experiences, I built strong spiritual discipline and learned the power of fellowship. Prayer became a lifestyle, and I grew in my understanding of God's Word. My social experiences were a mix of joy and hard lessons. In my first year, I met Mercy, who became my closest friend. We bonded instantly and supported each other academically and emotionally. However, not all friendships lasted. I had a painful fallout with another friend I had trusted deeply, which left me withdrawn for a time. During holidays, I engaged in community service and short-term internships. I once volunteered to help a local NGO digitize their records and assist in a health campaign. These activities made me more socially aware and fueled my passion for public service and data-driven development. I also participated in online learning platforms outside class hours taking free courses on Coursera, reading tech blogs, and experimenting with small data science projects. I would often spend evenings refining my Python skills or building small data visualizations just for fun. These independent efforts helped me stay ahead academically and professionally.

Conclusion

From the dusty playgrounds of my village to the bustling lecture halls of university, my life outside school has been a rich landscape of exploration and growth. It is in these experiences that I discovered my voice, my strengths, and my passions. Whether through childhood play, stage performances, late-night prayers, or small business struggles, each moment contributed to the person I am today resilient, curious, compassionate, and ready to take on the world with purpose and faith. Role Models and Inspirations Throughout my journey in life, I have been fortunate to encounter individuals whose influence and guidance have helped shape the person I am today. These role models, both personal and public, have played a significant part in defining my values, my dreams, and my determination to keep pushing forward.

At the very heart of my inspiration are my parents. My father's diligence and wisdom, coupled with my mother's unwavering love and strength, taught me the value of hard work, humility, and resilience. They modeled what it means to build a life based on faith, family, and responsibility. Their sacrifices and commitment to giving us a better life will always be the foundation on which I stand. In my academic journey, several teachers left a lasting impact. Teacher Felix, my primary school mathematics teacher, was instrumental in unlocking my passion for mathematics. His creative approach, patience, and belief in my potential made me believe that I could excel in the subject. In high school, Mr. Kamau transformed my attitude towards Mathematics. Through his structured teaching methods and genuine care for students, he turned what was once my weakest subject into one of my strongest. Mr. Manyara, though feared for his strictness, instilled discipline and precision in business studies, pushing me to reach academic heights I hadn't imagined possible.

Spiritually, I owe much of my growth to my church leaders and fellowship mentors in campus who continually guided me toward a deeper relationship with God. Their 14 teachings, prayers, and support helped me stay grounded in faith, even during difficult times. Among public figures, I have always admired the wisdom and grace of Michelle Obama. Her story, resilience, and commitment to education and service have inspired me deeply. I am also moved by the work of Dr. Myles Munroe, whose teachings on purpose, leadership, and faith challenged me to live intentionally and pursue destiny with courage and clarity. All these individuals, in their own ways, have nurtured my vision, stirred my potential, and challenged me to rise above mediocrity. Their lives continue to light my path, reminding me that greatness begins with service, humility, and the willingness to keep growing.

Quotes or Verses That Shaped Me Over the course of my journey, a number of quotes and Bible verses have deeply resonated with me, offering strength in times of struggle, wisdom in moments of confusion, and encouragement when I needed it most. These words have not only inspired me but have also become principles by which I try to live.

"I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me." - Philippians 4:13. This verse reminded me that even in the hardest of times—whether it was missing exams due to financial challenges or navigating broken friendships my strength was not in myself alone, but in the One who sustains me.

"For I know the plans I have for you," declares the Lord, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you a future and a hope." - Jeremiah 29:11. Whenever I felt lost or uncertain about the future, this promise reassured me that my life had purpose, direction, and divine guidance. "Hardships often prepare ordinary people for an extraordinary destiny."– C.S. Lewis This quote helped me reframe challenges as opportunities for growth, especially during times in campus when I had to juggle academics, business, and personal struggles. "Service to others is the rent you pay for

your room here on Earth."– Muhammad Ali This quote guided my outlook toward community engagement and leadership. It reminded me that life's greatest calling is not success, but service. "Grace isn't a little prayer you say before receiving a meal. It's a way to live."– Calvince Omiti. Living under grace shaped how I view myself and others—with compassion, patience, and humility. These words, etched in my heart, have acted as anchors through life's storms and compasses when I needed direction. They continue to influence my thoughts, actions, and aspirations as I grow. Hobbies, Expressions of Joy, Growth, and Identity Hobbies are more than just activities we do in our spare time they are expressions of who we are. They reflect our interests, help us cope with stress, and often become tools through which we discover our purpose. My hobbies have changed and evolved over time, shaped by my environment, opportunities, and the seasons of life I've passed through. From imaginative childhood games to meaningful adult pastimes, each hobby has played a role in my growth and identity.

Reading

Reading has always been one of my favorite pastimes. It started in primary school when I would borrow storybooks from the school library. I loved African folktales, stories with strong morals, and fantasy stories that transported me to magical worlds. In high school, my reading interests deepened. I started reading African literature like The River Between by Ngugi wa Thiong'o and Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe. These stories helped me connect with my heritage and develop empathy for different life experiences. I also developed an interest in Christian books, devotionals, and inspirational biographies that shaped my spiritual and intellectual growth. In university, I've expanded into reading non-fiction especially books on entrepreneur ship, personal development, psychology, and technology. Whether it's a novel, a devotional, or a tech blog, reading relaxes my mind, expands my worldview, and keeps me intellectually engaged. Writing and Journaling Writing has been a natural extension of my reading hobby.

As a child, I often created stories and poems, inspired by my imagination and the tales I heard from my grandmother. I would write down thoughts in my school notebooks or scribble lyrics to imaginary songs. Later in life, I turned to journaling. Writing became a private space for me to process 17 my emotions, reflect on life, and document personal victories. In campus, I began writing devotionals and messages of encouragement, which I would share with my close friends and church group. I've even considered starting a blog someday to share my thoughts on faith, life, and growth.

Cooking and Trying New Recipes Growing up in a family where food was part of every celebration and family gathering, I developed a deep appreciation for cooking. I remember helping my mother roll chapatis and peel potatoes from a young age. In high school, we only cooked during home science practicals, but I loved it every time. In campus, I've embraced cooking fully. I enjoy experimenting with new recipes trying out

pancakes with twists, creating samosas from scratch, or blending unique juice combinations. Cooking is therapeutic. It teaches patience, creativity, and gives me joy when others enjoy the meals I prepare. Entrepreneurship What started as a need has now grown into one of my most cherished hobbies. In university, I began selling snacks biscuits, crisps, samosas, and drinks to earn some money.

Over time, I began to enjoy the hustle. I learned how to budget, manage inventory, market my products, and deal with different types of customers. I'd find myself watching YouTube videos on how to improve small businesses or reading articles about side hustles. While this started out of necessity, entrepreneurship has become a skill and a hobby I genuinely love. It keeps me thinking, planning, and growing. Walking and Spending Time in Nature I've always enjoyed taking long walks especially in the early mornings or late afternoons. Even as a child, I would walk with my siblings to the river or to fetch water, and we'd 18 enjoy the scenery. In campus, the cool Nyeri weather and beautiful environment provide the perfect setting for thoughtful walks.

Walking gives me clarity. I often take time to reflect, pray, or listen to worship music or inspirational podcasts as I walk. It's my way of resetting my thoughts and reconnecting with myself and nature. Helping Others and Volunteering I've discovered that serving others is something I truly enjoy. Whether it was helping classmates with difficult subjects, organizing small church events, or volunteering during health campaigns, I always find fulfillment in being useful. In high school, I participated in tree planting and market cleanup activities.

In campus, I joined fellowship groups where I helped organize charity drives and community outreach. Volunteering reminds me that life is about more than just personal success it's about impact. Digital Learning and Tech Exploration in recent years, I've developed a love for online learning. I've taken free courses on Coursera and YouTube about data science, Python programming, and personal finance. I enjoy experimenting with new tools, trying out new apps, or building basic data visualizations. This hobby not only aligns with my career path but also satisfies my curiosity. Watching Documentaries and Inspirational Content in my free time, I enjoy watching documentaries especially those about history, nature, and human behavior. I also like watching Christian sermons, TED Talks, and interviews with successful people. These sources keep me informed, inspired, and connected to real-world stories that matter.

Conclusion

My hobbies have not only brought me joy they've helped shape who I am. They've allowed me to express creativity, build confidence, deepen my faith, and discover hidden talents. Whether it's through singing, reading, cooking, walking, or running a small business, I've learned that these seemingly small interests can open doors to lifelong passions and meaningful impact.

My hobbies are not just a way to pass time they are part of my journey toward becoming the best version of myself. Community Engagement Community has always been an integral part of my life. From a young age, I was taught that giving back is not just a noble act, but a responsibility we carry as members of society. My earliest memories of community involvement began during my time in Sunday school, where we would visit elderly members of the village, pray with them, sing hymns, and deliver small gifts during special church holidays like Easter and Christmas.

These simple acts planted seeds of empathy in my heart and taught me that even the smallest gestures can bring warmth and joy to someone's life. In primary school, our involvement in environmental initiatives was another form of community engagement. We took part in cleaning campaigns within the school compound and occasionally in the surrounding villages. We collected litter, planted trees, and helped maintain the cleanliness of our learning environment. Although I was young, I took pride in being part of a team working together to care for our surroundings. I felt a sense of unity, purpose, and accomplishment that would stay with me for years.

As I progressed to high school, my sense of responsibility deepened. My role as a class prefect meant I was frequently involved in organizing school-wide initiatives, from hygiene campaigns to mentorship sessions for younger students. One of my most memorable moments came during a tree-planting exercise, where we worked alongside students from neighboring schools and local environmental groups. We planted trees, cleaned riverbanks, and engaged in discussions about climate change and sustainability.

These experiences broadened my worldview and sparked a desire to be part of lasting solutions. High school also gave me the opportunity to serve in fellowship groups, where we encouraged one another spiritually and supported new students as they transitioned into school life. I led prayer meetings, participated in small group studies, and helped organize outreach visits to nearby schools and churches. The relationships built during these times were rooted in mutual encouragement and a shared desire to grow in faith and character. In campus, community engagement took on a more structured and mature form.

Through Christian Union, I was involved in multiple outreach missions in rural communities. We conducted health awareness campaigns, distributed sanitary towels to young girls, and held mentorship sessions where we shared not just academics, but life lessons and spiritual truths. These moments revealed to me the deep needs in society emotional, financial, and spiritual and affirmed my calling to serve beyond myself. One of the most impactful seasons of community service was during the COVID-19 pandemic. I joined a student-led initiative that distributed face masks, hand sanitizers, and food parcels to vulnerable families around Nyeri.

The gratitude we received was overwhelming, and it reminded me that acts of service, no matter how small, are deeply meaningful when done with love. Mentorship also became a personal mission. I tutored a number of first-year students in Data analysis and a bit of coding for website development, helped organize revision groups, and offered emotional support to those struggling with campus life. Having once needed guidance myself, I understood how vital it was to be present for someone else. Community engagement for me has never been limited to large projects or grand gestures.

It is in the little things checking in on a struggling friend, sharing encouraging words, helping someone find direction, or simply being present. Even through digital platforms like WhatsApp and social media, I have tried to share messages of hope, inspiration, and motivation. Looking ahead, I carry with me the vision of building platforms that empower and uplift others, especially young women in rural areas. My dream is to create mentorship and empowerment programs that focus on education, faith, and self-confidence. Community has shaped me, strengthened me, and blessed me and I intend to do the same for others.

Skill Building and Certifications

In the field of Information Technology, learning is a continuous process. The industry evolves rapidly, with new technologies, tools, and methodologies emerging constantly. To remain relevant and competitive, one must commit to lifelong learning. This understanding has driven me to pursue additional certifications and to continuously expand my skill set beyond the university curriculum.

In April 2023, I earned my Computer Network Certificate from the Cisco Networking Academy. This certification was a significant milestone in my technical education. The course covered a wide range of topics related to computer networking, including configuring switches and end devices, understanding physical and data link layer protocols, and troubleshooting connectivity issues in small networks. I learned how to configure routers to enable end-to-end connectivity between remote devices and how to create IPv4 and IPv6 addressing schemes.

The Cisco Networking course was intensive and required dedication, but it was also incredibly rewarding. Networking is the backbone of modern IT infrastructure, and understanding how networks function is essential for anyone working in technology. The hands-on labs, simulations, and practical exercises gave me a deep understanding of how data flows across networks, how devices communicate, and how security can be implemented to protect network resources.

Building on this foundation, I pursued another certification in August 2024: the Linux Essentials Professional Development Certificate, also from the Cisco Networking Academy. Linux is a powerful and widely-used operating system, especially in server environments, cloud computing, and development work. Understanding Linux is crucial

for anyone aspiring to work in IT, and this certification provided me with the knowledge and skills needed to navigate the Linux system confidently.

Through the Linux Essentials course, I learned to understand the Linux operating system, to navigate its file system and directory structure, and to execute powerful commands from the command line. I gained knowledge of Linux security, file permissions, and system administration tasks. The command line, often intimidating to beginners, became a tool of empowerment. I learned to perform complex tasks efficiently, to automate processes through scripting, and to troubleshoot issues that would be difficult to resolve through graphical interfaces alone.

These certifications are more than just credentials—they represent competencies that I have developed through rigorous study and practice. They validate my skills in the eyes of potential employers and demonstrate my commitment to professional development. But beyond their professional value, these certifications have deepened my understanding of technology and expanded the range of problems I can solve.

In addition to formal certifications, I have also dedicated time to learning on my own. I have explored programming languages such as Java and C++, delving into object-oriented programming, data structures, and algorithms. I have worked on web development projects, building websites from scratch using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. I have experimented with database management systems, learning how to design efficient databases and write complex queries. I have even ventured into Android app development, creating simple mobile applications as a way to understand the mobile ecosystem.

Each new skill I acquire opens up new possibilities. Technology is a vast and interconnected field, and the more I learn, the more I realize how much there is still to discover. But this realization does not discourage me—it excites me. It fuels my curiosity and motivates me to keep pushing forward, to keep exploring, and to keep growing.

My journey of skill-building is far from over. I plan to pursue additional certifications in areas such as cybersecurity, cloud computing, and data science. I want to become a well-rounded IT professional, capable of working across different domains and adapting to the changing demands of the industry. Each certification, each course, and each project is a step toward that goal, and I am committed to making the most of every learning opportunity that comes my way.

Achievements and Awards

Throughout my journey from childhood to university, I have been privileged to receive various recognitions and awards that reflect my commitment, growth, and determination. In primary school, my passion for mathematics began to shine in Class Seven. I consistently scored the highest marks in mathematics, earning recognition from teachers and classmates. During the school’s end-of-year prize-giving ceremony in

Class Eight, I was awarded the Best Student in Mathematics—an award that greatly boosted my confidence and deepened my love for numbers. High school was a transformative phase where I embraced both academics and co-curricular activities.

I was appointed class prefect in Form Three, a role that came with responsibilities and helped develop my leadership and communication skills. Under my prefect-ship, my class remained one of the most organized and disciplined, which earned me recognition during a school assembly as one of the Best Class Leaders of the Year. One of my most cherished achievements was my participation in the drama club. Our team progressed from the zonal to the national level, where I played a key role in our winning performance. I received a Certificate of Excellence in Performance, and the experience helped me develop confidence and public speaking skills. In the church, I was actively involved in youth ministry. I often led praise and worship and helped organize Sunday School activities.

I was recognized by our youth pastor for my consistency, humility, and leadership, and was awarded a Certificate of Service during a youth conference. At the university level, I ventured into entrepreneurship through my snack-selling business. While there were no formal certificates, this business became a huge personal milestone. It taught me the value of financial independence, customer service, and resilience. Through it, I managed to support myself financially during tough times and even inspired others to start their own ventures. Each of these achievements academic, spiritual, leadership, and entrepreneurial reminds me of how far I've come, not just in ability, but in character.

They are small yet powerful affirmations of the strength God has placed in me and the purpose that drives me forward. Languages Language has always played a vital role in shaping how I connect with others and understand the world around me. My first language is Kamba, the beautiful and melodic tongue of my Kamba heritage. It is the language I first heard as a child, spoken by my parents, whispered in lullabies, and echoed in village conversations. Kamba holds deep cultural significance for me.

Through it, I absorbed proverbs, folk tales, and wisdom passed down through generations. It gave me a sense of identity, belonging, and pride in my roots. As I started school and ventured into more formal learning environments, I was introduced to Kiswahili, the national language of Kenya and a bridge across many ethnic communities. Kiswahili opened my world to a broader spectrum of communication. I came to appreciate its poetic rhythm and rich vocabulary. From classroom discussions to church sermons and national news broadcasts, Kiswahili helped me grow as a confident speaker and an attentive listener.

Today, I am proficient in Kiswahili and use it fluently in both formal and informal settings. English, on the other hand, became the language of academia, global exposure, and self-expression in a wider world. I learned English gradually, starting with basic

greetings and sentences, until I could write essays, read novels, and speak it with ease. English became my language of instruction in school, the medium through which I interacted with the digital world, and the language I often use in professional and academic writing.

It gave me access to a wealth of knowledge and helped me connect with people beyond borders. Each of these three languages has shaped a unique part of me. Kikuyu roots me in tradition, Kiswahili connects me to my national identity, and English empowers me to explore and communicate globally. I am deeply grateful to be trilingual it has made me more adaptable, culturally aware, and expressive in different environments. My journey with language is not just about communication it’s about understanding, bridging gaps, and celebrating the richness of diversity.

Conclusion

As I bring this autobiography to a close, I find myself reflecting with immense gratitude on the journey that has shaped me into the person I am today. From the laughter-filled days of childhood in the warm embrace of my rural village, through the structured rigors of primary and high school, to the complex yet liberating world of campus life, every season has been a chapter of transformation. Each stage came with its joys, lessons, challenges, and turning points. I discovered the power of curiosity in my early years, the importance of resilience in moments of change, and the beauty of growth in times of discomfort. Through friendships gained and lost, moments of triumph and trial, I have been shaped into a woman of strength, compassion, and purpose. Education gave me knowledge, but life outside the classroom taught me wisdom. My business ventures, my leadership roles, and my spiritual journey all contributed to a deeper understanding of myself and my place in the world. I have learned to dream big but stay grounded, to aim for excellence while remaining humble, and to trust in God’s timing and grace above all else. As I stand on the threshold of a new season armed with experience, faith, and vision I carry with me the memories of where I have come from and the hope of where I am going. This is not the end of my story, but rather the beginning of a new chapter. I am excited to see what lies ahead, knowing that I am prepared, not because I have all the answers, but because I have learned how to seek, listen, and grow.